GRE Improvement Tracker and Error Log

Diagnostic Forensic Audit, Section-Adaptive Algorithm Navigation, 8-Week Timeline & 4-Bucket Error Taxonomy

1. The 8-Week Diagnostic-to-Test-Day GRE Improvement Framework

A structured 56-day timeline designed by IIT Roorkee alumni to reliably boost your GRE score by 10 to 20 total points.

Preparation Phase	Weekly Timeline	Primary Academic Focus	Key Milestone Deliverable
Phase 1: Diagnostic Baseline	Week 1 (Days 1–7)	ETS Official PowerPrep Practice Test 1; Quant/Verbal error inventory	Complete error log classification by question subtype
Phase 2: High-Frequency Vocabulary	Weeks 2–3 (Days 8–21)	Master 600 high-frequency GRE words; Text Completion logic pairing	Zero vocabulary definition gaps on medium difficulty questions
Phase 3: Quant Core Foundations	Week 4 (Days 22–28)	Arithmetic, Algebra, Geometry, and Quantitative Comparison traps	Quant accuracy >= 85% on sub-160 level problem sets
Phase 4: Mid-Point Recalibration	Week 5 (Days 29–35)	ETS PowerPrep Practice Test 2 under strict timed conditions	Validate score trajectory (+6 to +10 point increase)
Phase 5: Speed & Hard Problems	Week 6 (Days 36–42)	3-Blank Text Completion, Data Interpretation, and 165+ Quant sets	Master the 1-minute discard rule on complex QC traps
Phase 6: Section Adaptation Drills	Week 7 (Days 43–49)	Timed sectional sets simulating Hard Section 2 adaptation	Eliminate fatigue drop-off across back-to-back timed sections
Phase 7: Test Simulation & Taper	Week 8 (Days 50–56)	PowerPrep Plus (Paid) Exam, formula review, vocabulary refresh	Execution of test-day pacing strategy with confidence

Total Weekly Commitment: 12-15 hours for working professionals; 20-25 hours for full-time students.

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2. The 4-Bucket GRE Error Taxonomy Template

Classify every missed practice question into one of 4 diagnostic buckets to apply the correct remediation.

Error Classification Bucket	Psychological / Technical Cause	Immediate Corrective Action	Weekly Verification Drill
Bucket 1: Vocabulary Deficit	Did not know the secondary or tertiary definition of a key word	Add word to digital spaced-repetition flashcards with synonyms	Test retention via active recall drill after 48 hours
Bucket 2: Constraint Oversight	Missed hidden math constraints (e.g. x is an integer, x != 0, x < y)	Circle all numerical constraints on physical scratchpad before solving	Execute 15 Quantitative Comparison trap questions
Bucket 3: Pacing Panic / Rush	Ran out of time; guessed hastily on the final 3-4 questions in section	Enforce 1m30s per question average; practice skipping hard items	Run timed 10-question sprints in 15 minutes
Bucket 4: Execution / Arithmetic Slip	Minus sign error, clicked wrong radio button, misread question prompt	Write neat numbered calculations on scratch paper; re-read prompt	Pause 3 seconds before confirming answer to check final units

Gold Standard: Maintain an active Error Log with at least 150 deeply analyzed questions before test day.

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3. Navigating the GRE Section-Adaptive Algorithm

How Section 1 performance dictates your score ceiling and floor in the modern shorter GRE.

- Section 1 Is Decisive: Getting 13+ out of 18 questions correct in Section 1 routes you to the Hard Section 2, unlocking a score ceiling of 170.
- The Scoring Floor Benefit: Even if you struggle in the Hard Section 2, ETS awards bonus points that protect your score from dropping below ~155.
- Avoid the Easy Section Trap: Getting fewer than 7 correct in Section 1 routes you to the Easy Section 2, capping your maximum possible score at ~152.
- Review Every Question: Unlike the GMAT, the GRE allows you to mark, skip, and revisit any question within the active section.